

Text-Subtext

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Introduction

Welcome to the 'Text-Subtext' module inside the Copywriting 101 course. In this module, we'll cover the difference between the text and subtext and how you can manipulate both to influence readers.

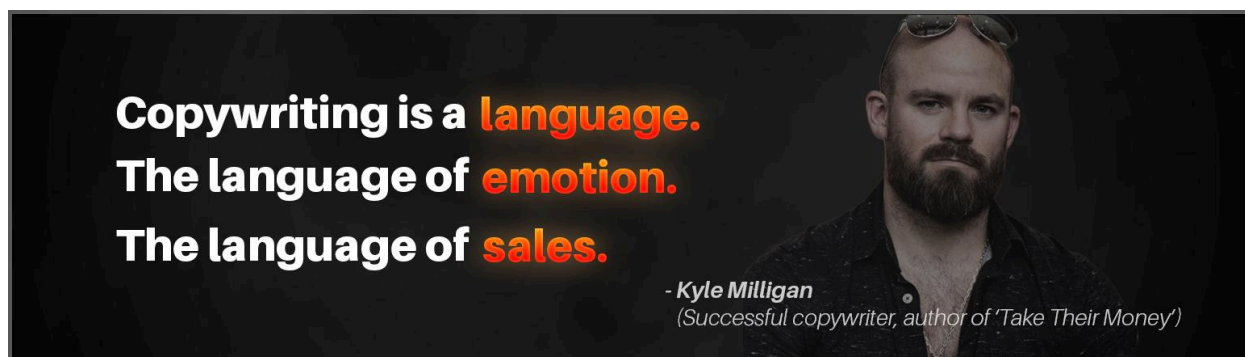
DISCLAIMER: I *highly* recommend watching every previous module before this module. We'll be building on the concepts we learned there. If you don't understand those concepts in depth, applying the concepts you'll learn here will be hard, if not impossible.

Link to the FULL video version: [Text-Subtext Video](#)

Link to the mastersheet: [Copywriting Mastersheet](#)

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The Language



A well-respected and successful copywriter, Kyle Milligan, explains in his book 'Take Their Money' that copywriting is best viewed as a *language*.

> *The language of copywriting exists to speak to the reader's emotions.*

The reason most people find the skill of copywriting difficult to master is that they think they can 'learn a few words' of the copywriting language and go make millions..

- *Learning a few basic frameworks...*
- *Copying someone's sales page headline & changing a few words...*

- Using words like 'Breakthrough' and 'WARNING' just cuz other writers do...

That doesn't make you a skilled copywriter — *just like memorizing a few Spanish words doesn't make you a fluent Spanish speaker!*

In this module, we're going to break down the fundamentals of this 'language' we call copywriting and then go over a simple way you can learn to speak this language fluently as fast as possible.

Subtext

As stated above, copywriting speaks to emotions.

Great copy provokes emotions, those emotions provoke action, and action leads to sales.

The art of copywriting is learning how to trigger the 'emotional' part of the brain — and that is done by focusing on the 'sub-text' of what you're writing.

> *The WHY you're writing what you're writing.*

> *How you want the reader to FEEL.*



Text (how) - the literal words you're writing.

Subtext (why) - the emotion/feeling you're trying to push.

Let's look at some examples:

> Text: *That's why we're giving you this step-by-step solution.*

> Subtext: *Wow! This will be so much easier with this thing.*

> Text: *What you're about to read will cause a FALLOUT in the online business world.*

> Subtext: *Oh my... this is important. I need to read this.*

> Text: *History is repeating itself.*

> Subtext: *This seems pretty safe. If it's happened before, then I'll know what to expect.*

> Text: **WARNING.**

> Subtext: *This is dangerous/important. I need to pay attention.*

> Text: **Breakthrough Discovery.**

> Subtext: *This is brand-new, there's probably a lot of opportunity. I need to get in on this before people catch on.*

> Text: **If that's you, don't worry.**

> Subtext: *This person understands me, I can trust them, they'll probably help me.*

In great copy, every sentence plays a specific role in persuading the audience to take action. No lines are wasted.

As you're learning to write compelling copy, focus on WHY you're writing this sentence before you worry about WHAT you write.

The 4 Core Emotions (General Conditions)

***If you haven't seen 'Specific Conditions', go watch that module **BEFORE** continuing.

***Kyle Milligan covers these as 'NESB' in his book, *Take Their Money*. Check out that book for his full perspective.



As we discussed in the previous module, we can divide the human brain into two categories:

> **General Conditions**

> **Specific Conditions**

In the last module, we covered how to find and leverage the **specific conditions** of your audience. In this module, we'll cover **4 big general conditions** that we'll use in every piece of copy.

These are the **four general conditions** that every human comes pre-programmed with. No matter who you're writing to, you'll be appealing to one or more of these four emotions in some aspect.

1. Easy

Simplicity Theory: This principle suggests that people have a natural bias towards simplicity and prefer experiences that minimize cognitive load.

> Translation: *We want stuff to be easy.*

In your copy, you want the action you're persuading them to take to be as easy as possible.

Let's look at some ways we can push the 'easy' emotion:
(Most statements you find will hit multiple of these at once.)

a. Decreasing the time investment (time)

- > *In just a few minutes*
- > *6-minute six-pack*
- > *2-hour writer*
- > *You can earn \$400/day starting next Monday*
- > *This 20-sec trick allows you to...*
- > *All of this by clicking a few buttons for 15 minutes a day*

b. Decreasing the effort investment (work)

- > *All of this by 'clicking a few buttons' for 15 minutes a day*
- > *You can get (results) WITHOUT (the hard work they hate)*
- > *Step-by-step*
- > *All you have to do is...*

c. Decreasing the intelligence required (smarts)

- > *You don't have to be a financial expert*
- > *High-school dropouts are taking advantage of this to make \$333/day*
- > *Simple*

d. Decreasing the resources required (money)

- > *With only \$100...*
- > *All you need is \$1 a day*
- > *You don't have to have millions in the bank*

e. Decreasing the chance required (luck)

- > *Anybody*
- > *You don't need NFL genetics*
- > *People who look like the opposite of Tom Cruise are landing hot dates weekly*

- > *There's 0% luck required*
- > *Fool-proof*
- > *Proven*

Kyle calls 'anybody' the alter-ego of Easy. If you can show how anyone can succeed with your 'thing'. People will believe they can succeed with it, regardless of their pre-existing limiting beliefs.

Words to look for when decoding someone pushing the 'easy' emotion:

> *Easy, Anybody, Simple, Fool-proof, Step-by-step, System, You don't need, All you have to do is..., You don't have to be..., etc.*

***We'll cover live examples from profitable copy later in this module.

2. Safe

Risk Aversion Theory: This theory describes the human tendency to prefer a sure, lower outcome over a gamble with a potentially higher payoff but also a chance of loss.

People prioritize not losing > winning.

Studies show that people were much more willing to walk 2 miles to retrieve money they'd lost than they were to walk 2 miles to gain that same amount of money.

> *Translation: We want stuff to be safe.*

In your copy, you want the action you want them to take to appear as 'safe' as possible.

The main way to push the 'safe' emotion is to highlight how 'sure' this opportunity is. Show how this opportunity is predictable/following the same pattern as a previous time.

Try to decrease the perceived downside risk of taking your action as close to 0 as possible.

- a. *We've helped over 85+ copywriters just like you sign paying clients.*
- b. *Proven*
- c. *Predictable*
- d. *This is the safest way to...*
- e. *History is repeating itself...*
- f. *The last time this happened...*

Kyle calls 'predictable' the alter-ego of Safe. If you can show how predictable they're results will be. People will believe this opportunity is safe.

***We'll cover live examples from profitable copy later in this module.

3. New

Psychology of New: The "psychology of new" explores how individuals respond to novel experiences and the mental benefits of embracing new things. It encompasses concepts like the fresh start effect, the release of dopamine in the brain, and the stimulation of neuroplasticity. Essentially, it examines the psychological impact of novelty, including increased motivation, improved mood, and boosted confidence.

> Translation: *We love new stuff.*

Kyle Milligan and other expert copywriters consider 'new' to be the most important emotion you can push, stating, '*categorization is DEATH.*'

People want something new, not an improvement offer — new, NOT better.

Without seeming 'new,' people will immediately categorize your copy/opportunity as 'something they've seen before' and move on with their day.

In your copy, you want the opportunity you're selling to seem as 'new' as possible.

****This is also why copying the latest outreach technique from a YouTube guide with thousands of views rarely works. The method is no longer 'new' to the market. People have seen it before.*

****This is why you HAVE to become a first-principle thinker. If you don't learn how to create tactics that are brand NEW, you'll never get to reap the benefits of being 'first' to an effective technique.*

There are many ways to create the 'new' emotion, largely dependent on what you're selling. Here are a few words you can look for when decoding copy for the 'new' emotion:

> *NEW, Breakthrough, Discovery, One-Of-A-Kind, Disruptive, Game-Changing, Revealed*

The goal is to create these 'epiphanies' in your audience's head that give them that feeling of 'new' and create 'hope'.

We do this by creating concepts that are 'new' to our audience.

a. New Macro-Opportunity (*The big problem/method you're selling*)

- > Advertising VS Copywriting
- > Copywriting VS Digital Persuasion
- > Copywriting VS Ghostwriting
- > Marketing Agency VS SMMA
- > Consulting/Agency VS Growth Operating
- > Websites VS Funnels

b. New Micro-Opportunity (*A new part of the process that makes the 'method' effective.*)

- > Cold DM's VS Outreach Systems
- > Cold DM's VS High-Value Outreach
- > The Hyper-Learning Cycle
- > Emails VS Sales Pages

***Once again, what concept sounds NEW and BELIEVABLE to your audience... depends entirely on their specific conditions.

The KEY to a compelling 'new' opportunity is that it sounds unique and exciting while ALSO appealing to the logical part of their brain — ie, it's exciting/cool, makes sense, and sounds extremely believable. This takes some time to get good at, but just don't be corny or weird lol.

- > High-Value Outreach VS The KJ Method
- > High Value Outreach VS One-Of-A-Kind Outreach
- > The Hyper-Learning Cycle VS The Turbo-Info Method
- > The Unconventional Path VS The Secret Roadmap Of The Elite 1%'rs
- > Proven Inbound IG System VS The 4-Prong IG Explosion Method

***Once again, what concept sounds NEW and BELIEVABLE to your audience... depends entirely on their specific conditions.

Kyle calls 'only' the alter-ego of New. If you can show how this opportunity/thing is ONLY available through your offer, they'll inherently believe it's something brand-new.

***We'll cover live examples from profitable copy later in this module.

4. Big/FOMO (Fear Of Missing Out)

Psychology of Big: When an opportunity seems 'big', it demands attention, signifies importance, creates intrigue, and appears rewarding. This creates the 'fear of missing out' referred to as FOMO.

Psychology of FOMO: Fear of missing out is a psychological phenomenon characterized by anxiety or unease about the possibility of missing out on positive experiences or opportunities that others are having. It's often triggered by the desire to stay connected with what others are doing, and can lead to feelings of envy, dissatisfaction, and a sense that one's life is not as exciting or fulfilling as others.

> Translation: We pay attention to 'big' stuff and don't want to miss out on a 'big' opportunity everyone else gets in on.

Creating the 'big/fomo' can be a little more abstract than the previous three, but after some practice, you'll find it easy to spot in the copy you study. Here are some words you can look for:

> Big, Huge, Once-In-A-Lifetime, Breakthrough, Fast, Fastest-Growing, Only seen twice in history, World-Changing, this will change everything, Massive

You want readers to feel an overwhelming urge that something BIG is going on and they don't have time to wait... They need to act FAST before they MISS OUT.

This will also inherently happen as you nail the other three emotions, just remember that you need to have some HYPE in your copy!

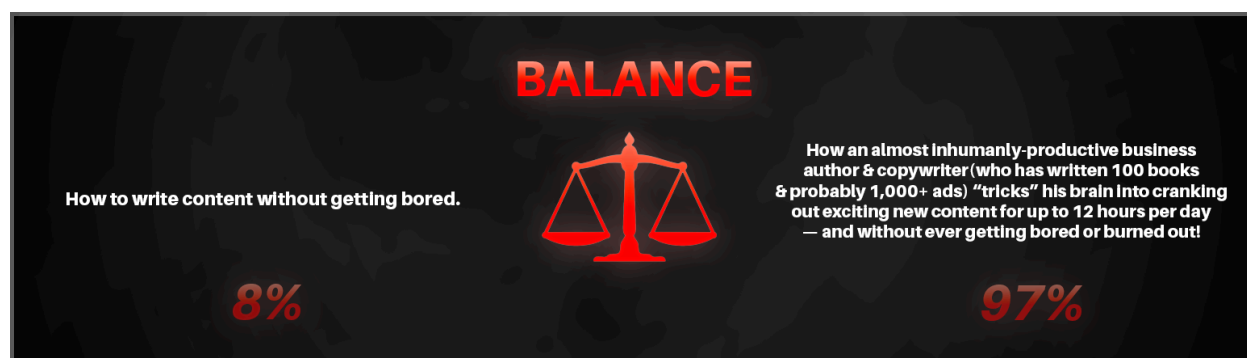
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Balance

Like everything in life, balance is key. If you push on these emotions too hard, your copy might come off as very 'salesy' or too dramatic.

***This is another area highly dependent on the specific conditions of your target audience. If you're targeting people who've been burned by more 'direct' and 'salesy' marketing in the past, they're more likely to respond negatively to that type of copy in the future.

All copy should push these emotions, but you have to determine how subtly/aggressively you want to push things based on your audience.



Both examples push the same emotion, but the right side displays when you *CRANK* the emotion, pushing it up 100%, where the left side pushes the same emotion much more subtly.

As mentioned above, there is no universal 'right' way to do it. It all depends on what you're selling and who you're selling to.

***As a great rule of thumb, I'd try to push your copy to 110% on the sales side to make sure you're pushing emotions, then in your editing, tone it down to a level you think your audience is comfortable with.

Learning The Language

The secret to making serious money with this skill is using the 'Hyper-Learning' cycle to learn the 'language' as fast as possible.

(This is exactly how I was able to make a year's progress in 2 months and hit \$10k/month the following month!)

Most people never make any money with this skill because they try to learn copywriting using the 'Snail Approach.'

The Snail Approach:

- > You spend 95% of your deep work time watching copywriting YouTube videos.
- > You spend 4% of your deep work time reading other people's copy — that probably isn't that good.
- > You spend 1% of your deep work writing your own copy.

That's a recipe for sub-par results at best.

Instead, I'd like to show you how to 'Hyper-Learn' the language of copywriting using a simple daily routine:



The Hyper-Learning Cycle (Copywriting)

1. **DO:** Write a piece of copy.
2. **LEARN:** Watch one of these modules again and take notes.
3. **STUDY:** Read a great piece of copy, break it down, and take notes.
(Will be provided to you in the Skool resources.)
4. **ITERATE:** Use your notes from learning and studying to rewrite your piece of copy from earlier.

We'll walk through this entire cycle together in the 'Synthesis' module, but for now, let's start by applying the concepts you've learned today.

Step 1: Pause the video and make a copy of this Miro board: [Text-Subtext Examples](#)

Step 2: Go line-by-line searching and making note of the core emotions/general conditions/subtext the writer is intending to push with the text.

Step 3: Resume this video and watch me break down the same copy to check your work.

Step 4: Repeat for each example.

I'll put together a giant resource of great copy that you can break down in the resource section in this module on Skool.

Just PROMISE me you won't overthink and spend 8 hours breaking down copy when you should be following the entire cycle! 😊

Iterating Subtext In Your Copy

To help make these concepts as tangible and useful as possible, I want to go over a step-by-step process you can use to improve the subtext (emotion-pushing) in your copy.

This is one of many processes we'll cover throughout this course, all of which you can use in the 'Iteration' phase of the Hyper-Learning Cycle.

When reviewing your copy, ask the following questions:

1. Which of the big 4 emotions do I think is the MOST important to push in this specific piece of copy, for this specific audience?
2. Where/how can I push the easy emotion more?
3. Where/how can I push the new emotion more?
4. Where/how can I push the safe emotion more?
5. Where/how can I push the big/fomo emotion more?
6. Based on my audience and this specific piece of copy, should I crank up the emotions or tone it down a bit?

If you continue to ask these questions, while keeping your audience's specific conditions top of mind, alongside studying how other copywriters push these emotions...

You'll be on the fast track to writing some extremely compelling copy in no time. 🚀

Quick Reminder:

If you want me to crank more modules like this one, and even better, let me know any wins/breakthroughs/thoughts you have on this module/course in the #★course-wins channel in the Discord. It gives me so much energy to know all the pain I go through making these is worth it haha. Love y'all and see you in the next module. ❤️ -KJ

Link to the FULL video version: [Text-Subtext Video](#)

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